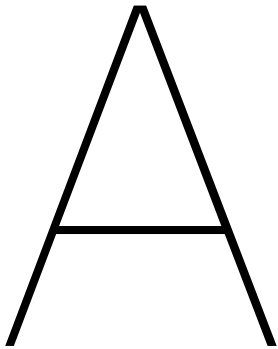


The Next Step

India's digital transformation has been fuelled by initiatives such as Aadhaar. Moving ahead, the country needs to incorporate emerging technologies and address concerns as more countries seek to emulate the digital infrastructure.

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AFTER SUCCESSFULLY DEMONSTRATING the prowess of India's digital public infrastructure (DPI) during the G20 Summit held here last year, the country is turning its focus towards the increased digitalisation of the economy as it aims to become developed by 2047.

It is building on initiatives like the identity system Aadhaar, the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), and the document-storing platform Di-giLocker that have ensured services are delivered efficiently, transparently, and directly to citizens.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, in her Union Budget speech on July 23, lauding the technologies for improving productivity and bridging inequality, said, "Public investment in digital infrastructure and innovations by the private sector has helped in improving access of all citizens, particularly the common people, to market resources, education, health, and services."

The focus now is on scaling this ecosystem, ensuring its responsible use, and exploring new frontiers. But this journey to a fully digital India is fraught with challenges that require careful navigation.

